Meridian Cloud Expense Policy

1. Scope and principles

This policy applies to all employees who spend company money on business purposes. Employees are expected to spend as if the money were their own. Expenses are reimbursed only when they are reasonable, necessary for business and supported by documentation. Personal expenses, fines and alcohol consumed without clients are never reimbursed. Spouse or family travel costs are not covered unless a vice president approves them in writing before the trip.

Meals while travelling are reimbursed up to the following limits per person: breakfast up to $15, lunch up to $25 and dinner up to $60. When entertaining customers, the dinner limit rises to $90 per person and the most senior employee at the table pays and claims the expense. Meals on regular office days are not reimbursable.

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2. Travel and accommodation

Flights must be booked in economy class through the company travel portal at least 14 days before departure when possible. Business class is allowed only for flights longer than 8 hours and requires vice president approval before booking. For flights shorter than 6 hours the economy fare is mandatory with no exceptions.

Hotel rooms are capped at $220 per night in tier-1 cities, which are London, New York, San Francisco and Tokyo. In all other cities the cap is $150 per night. Employees who exceed the cap must pay the difference themselves. Rental cars are permitted only when public transport is not practical, and the vehicle class must be compact or mid-size. Mileage for personal vehicles is reimbursed at $0.60 per mile.

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3. Claims and approvals

Expense reports must be submitted through ExpensePortal within 30 days of the expense date. Claims older than 30 days are rejected unless the finance team grants an exception. A receipt is required for every expense above $25. For expenses of $25 or less, a written description is sufficient.

A direct manager can approve claims up to $2,000. Claims above $2,000 additionally need approval from the finance director. Approved claims are paid within 10 business days in the next payroll run. The corporate card must be used for travel bookings, and card statements are reconciled monthly. Employees who leave the company must submit all outstanding claims before their last working day.